

Developer Workforce & Compensation Trends

2024 Stack Overflow Survey

65,437 respondents across 180+ countries

For Engineering Managers & HR Leaders

survey.stackoverflow.co/2024/work

84% of Developers Are Working, but Full-Time Employment Dips in the U.S.

69%

Full-Time Globally

16.4%

Freelance / Contracting

13.2%

Full-Time Students

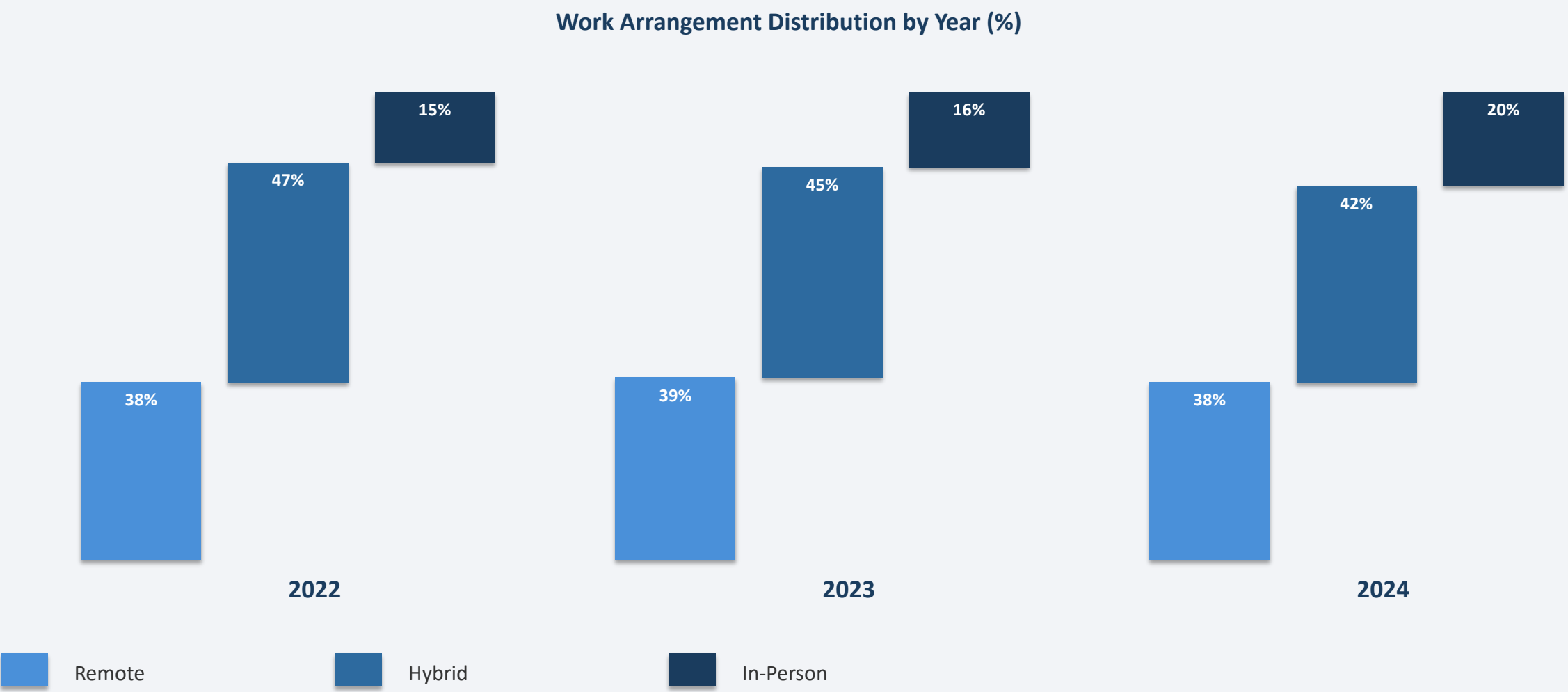
64.8%

Full-Time U.S. (↓ 4pts)

Global Employment Status Breakdown

Full-time employment remains dominant globally at 69%, with independent contracting/freelancing at 16.4% and full-time students at 13.2%. In the United States, full-time employment dropped from 69% in 2023 to 64.8% in 2024 — a 4 percentage-point year-over-year decline. In the U.K. and Ukraine, non-full-time respondents lean toward independent contracting, while in Germany and India they are more likely to be full-time students.

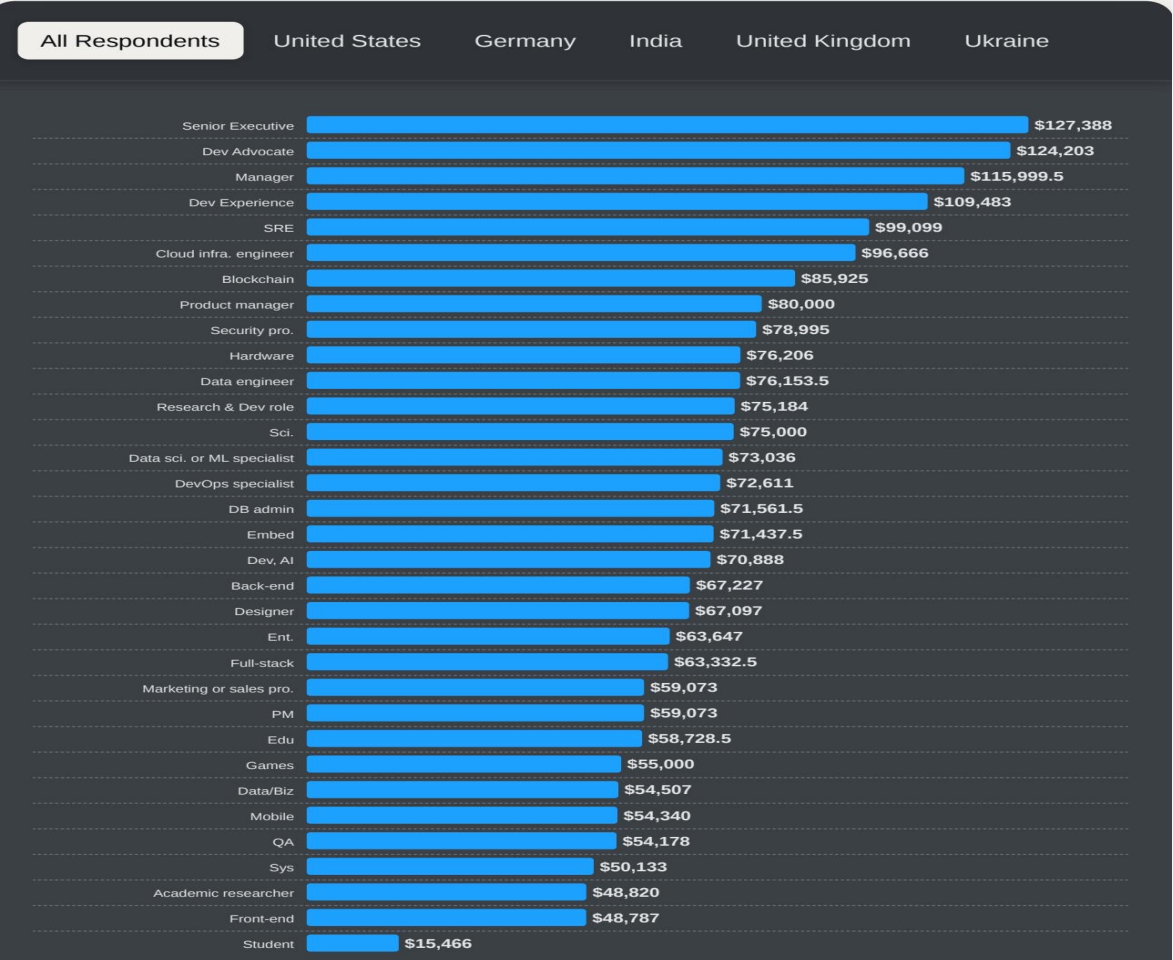
In-Person Work Rises to 20% While Hybrid Holds Steady at 42%



Hybrid work remains the most common arrangement at 42%, consistent with 2023. Remote work accounts for 38%. In-person work has risen for the third consecutive year — from 15% in 2022 to 16% in 2023 to 20% in 2024 — signaling a gradual return-to-office trend.

Source: Stack Overflow Developer Survey 2024

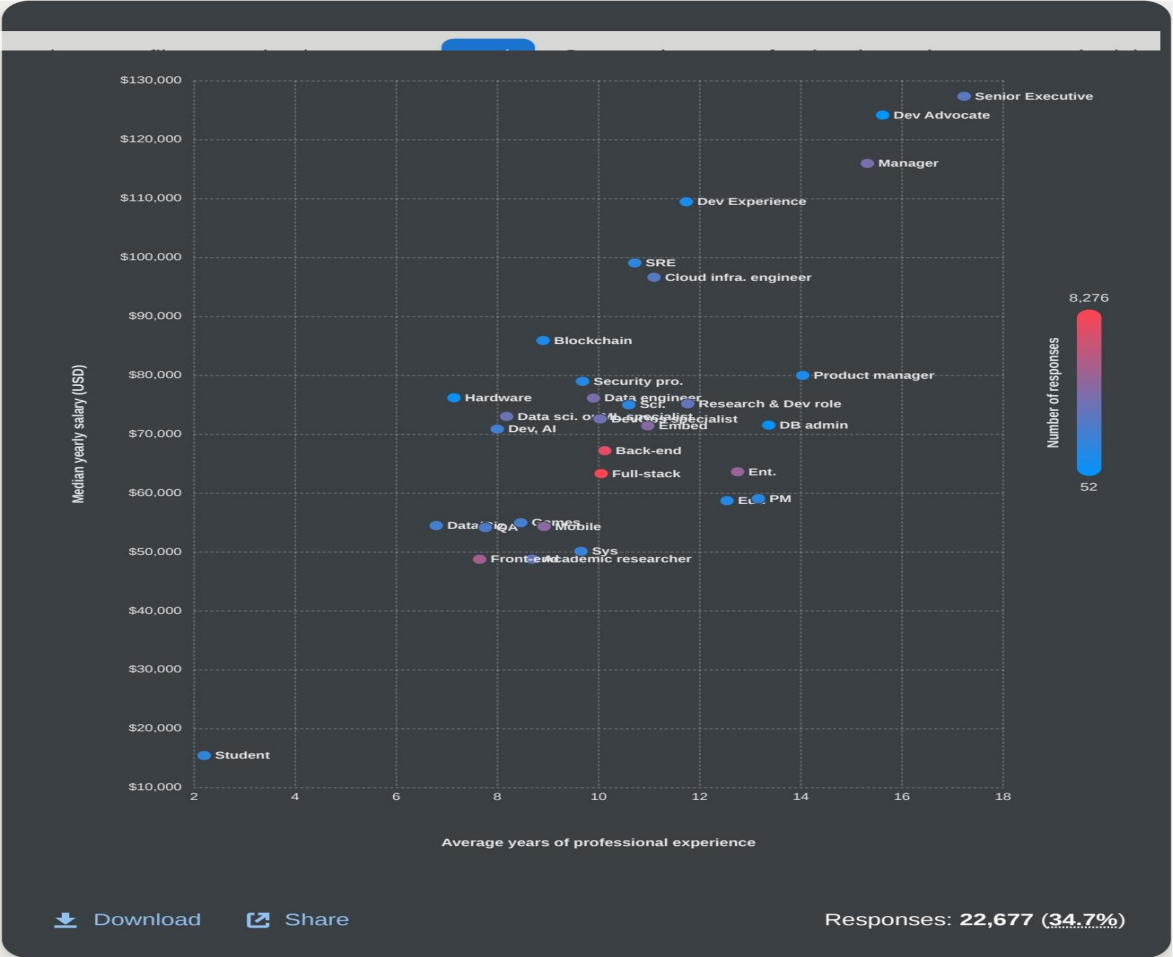
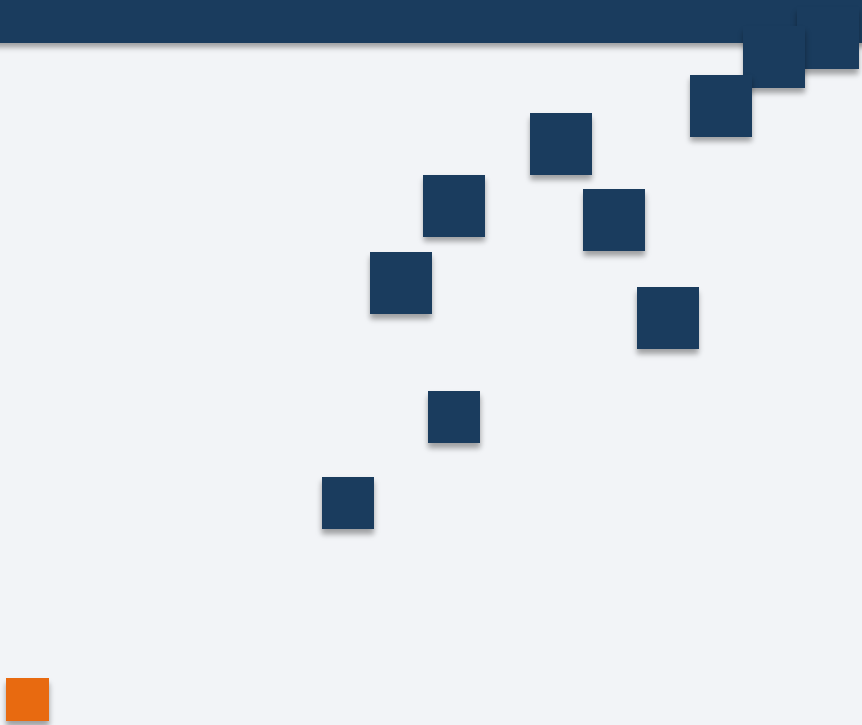
Senior Executives and Dev Advocates Top \$124K+ Median Salary



22,677 salary responses (34.7% response rate)

Source: Stack Overflow Developer Survey 2024

Experience Pays: Top Roles Combine 14+ Years with Six-Figure Salaries

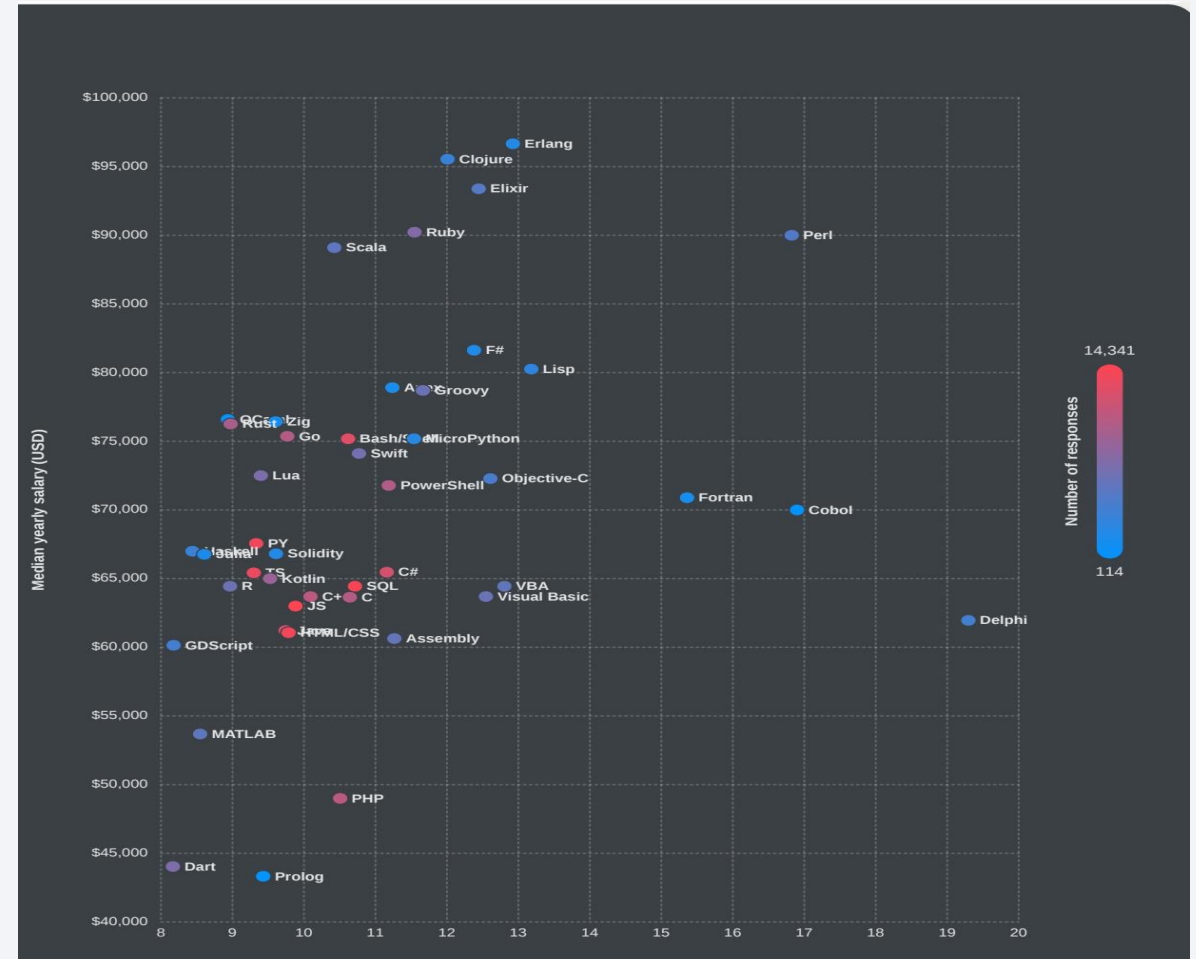
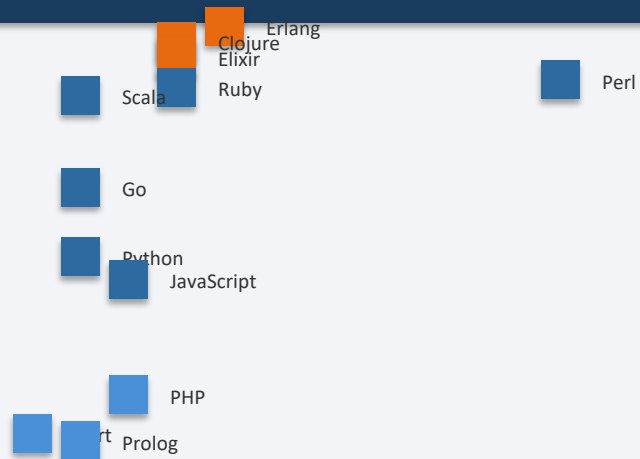


Bubble size $\propto$ number of respondents

A cluster of senior roles — Executive, Dev Advocate, Manager — occupy the upper-right, combining 15+ years of experience with six-figure salaries. Students are clear outliers at \$15K median despite ~2 years of experience, reflecting entry-level compensation levels.

Source: Stack Overflow Developer Survey 2024

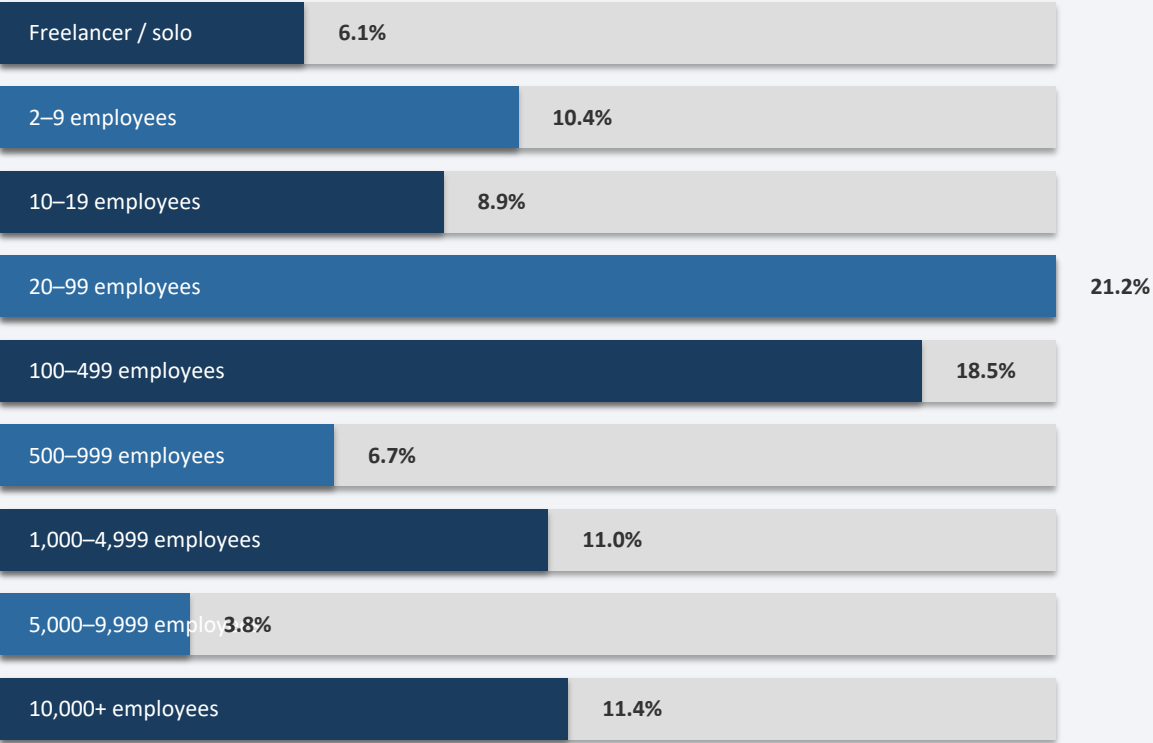
Erlang & Clojure Developers Earn >\$95K; Dart & Prolog Below \$45K



Developers using niche functional languages earn the most. The overall salary range has dropped ~\$10K vs. 2023 (now averaging \$60–75K vs. \$70–85K last year). Erlang, Clojure, and Elixir developers command premium pay >\$93K, while Dart, Prolog, and PHP sit below \$50K.
Source: Stack Overflow Developer Survey 2024

47% Work at Sub-100 Orgs; 62% Influence Tech Purchases

Company Size Distribution



Tech Purchasing Influence



Takeaways: What These Trends Mean for Hiring & Retention

1

Full-Time Employment Is Softening

U.S. full-time employment fell 4 percentage points YoY. Plan for more contractors and flexible workforce arrangements.

2

In-Person Mandates Growing, Hybrid Still Dominant

In-person work climbed to 20% (from 15% in 2022), but hybrid at 42% remains the plurality arrangement.

3

DevRel & Leadership Roles Command Premium Pay

Senior Executives (\$127K), Dev Advocates (\$124K), and Managers (\$116K) top the charts at 15+ years avg. experience.

4

Niche Language Skills Correlate with Higher Pay

Erlang, Clojure, and Elixir developers earn >\$93K median. Mainstream languages (PHP, Dart) sit well below \$50K.

5

Developers Are Key Purchase Influencers

62% of developers influence tech buying decisions. Engage individual contributors directly, not just leadership.